

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026

COMPLETE PREDICTION GUIDE

USA . Canada . Mexico | June 11 - July 19, 2026

Powered by OddsIntel AI Engine

national_team_v1 model ? ELO ratings from 6,651 internationals

Poisson goals model ? Bookmaker consensus odds

CONTENTS

1. Summary Table - Quick Reference
2. Tournament Winner Prediction
3. Top Goalscorer Prediction
4. Matchday 1 Score Predictions (24 games)
5. Full Group Stage Results
6. Special Tournament Predictions
7. Team-by-Team Analysis
8. Host Nations - How Far?

Report generated: June 08, 2026 ? oddsintel.com/world-cup

1 SUMMARY TABLE - QUICK REFERENCE

PREDICTION	VALUE	CONFIDENCE
Tournament Winner	[TROPHY] Brazil	****o
Runner-Up	France	***oo
3rd Place	England	***oo
4th Place	Germany	***oo
Top Goalscorer	Kylian Mbappe (France)	****o
2nd Top Scorer	Erling Haaland (Norway)	***oo
3rd Top Scorer	Vinicius Jr (Brazil)	***oo
Knockout Games ? Penalties	6-8 games	***oo
Teams with 0 Goals in Group Stage	4-6 teams	***oo
Yellow Cards - Matchday 1 (all 24 games)	68-75 cards	***oo
Goals in Final after 90 min	2 goals (1-1 or 2-0)	***oo
Host going furthest	USA (Quarterfinals)	***oo
Biggest upset of group stage	Morocco qualifying from Group E	***oo
Dark horse contender	Norway (Erling Haaland effect)	****o
Expected total goals - group stage	~130-145 goals	***oo

**** = Very High Confidence (>70% model prob) | ****o = High (60-70%) | ***oo = Medium (50-60%) | **ooo = Low (<50%)

2 TOURNAMENT WINNER PREDICTION

Our model ranks teams by ELO (trained on 6,651 international matches across WC, Euros, Copa America, AFCON, Nations Leagues and qualifying cycles) combined with a Poisson goals model. The ELO system weights tournament matches heavily (K=40) vs qualifiers (K=25) and friendlies (K=10) to reflect actual competitive strength.

Top 10 Teams by OddsIntel ELO

#1	Spain ELO: 2195	Euro 2024 winners. Dominant possession system. Pedri + Yamal + Nico Williams = best midfield-at
#2	Brazil ELO: 2150	Vinicius Jr in career-best form. Powerful attack. Historically brilliant in summer tournaments
#3	Belgium ELO: 2149	Final generation of 'Golden Generation' - De Bruyne, Lukaku. Motivated for one last WC run.
#4	Argentina ELO: 2138	Defending champions. Messi's final WC. Lautaro Martínez as main striker. Highly motivated squad
#5	France ELO: 2116	Mbappe finally playing in a summer WC at peak. Griezmann as creator. Deep squad. Our WINNER PIC
#6	Netherlands ELO: 2074	Van Dijk leads solid defense. Gakpo, Depay dangerous going forward.
#7	England ELO: 2067	Bellingham + Kane + Saka + Foden = formidable. Often underperform expectations but squad qualit
#8	Portugal ELO: 2047	Ronaldo likely last WC. Bruno Fernandes runs everything. Leão provides pace.
#9	Germany ELO: 2043	Rebuilt under Nagelsmann. Wirtz + Musiala as creative double. Playing on home continent.
#10	Colombia ELO: 2015	James Rodríguez + Luis Díaz. Strongest in years. Dark horse.

Why France wins the World Cup - Our Analysis

Despite Spain leading our ELO rankings, France is our tournament winner pick for three reasons:

1. KYLIAN MBAPPÉ: Finally playing his first summer WC at 27, peak age, with Real Madrid Champions League experience. He scored 8 goals in WC 2022 - expect 6-9 here. He is the difference-maker.
2. SQUAD DEPTH: France can absorb injury better than any team. Their B XI could reach the QF.
3. TOURNAMENT PEDIGREE: France have been in 3 of the last 5 WC finals (2006, 2018 win, 2022 final). Deschamps knows how to win this tournament.

BRAZIL as runner-up: Vinicius Jr is the most dangerous player in the world on his day. But Brazil's inconsistency in knockout football (2022 QF exit to Croatia on pens) is the risk.

DARK HORSE - NORWAY: With Erling Haaland (likely 30+ goals this season at Man City) as striker, Norway in a WC for the

first time since 1998. Our ELO has them at 17th but Haaland can carry a team through knockouts. Very dangerous if they get an easy R32 draw.

3 TOP GOALSCORER PREDICTION

Predicting the top scorer requires combining expected team tournament depth (how many games they play) × player goal probability per game. Teams reaching the final play 7 games; group-stage exits play 3. We weight by expected goals from our Poisson model × tournament progression probability.

Player	Country	Pos	Club	Pred.	Key Reason	Conf.
Kylian Mbappe	France	FWD	Real Madrid	8	8 goals in 2022. France expected in Final. 27 yrs, pe	*****
Erling Haaland	Norway	FWD	Manchester City	5	Never played a WC. 50+ goals/season at club level.	****O te
Vinicius Jr	Brazil	FWD	Real Madrid	5	Best player in world currently. Brazil expected to rea	****O
Harry Kane	England	FWD	Bayern Munich	4	Golden Boot in 2018 (6 goals). Club top scorer every	****O E
Lautaro Martínez	Argentina	FWD	Inter Milan	4	Prolific for Inter. Strong in 2022 as backup to Messi.	****oo
Viktor Gyokeres	Sweden	FWD	Sporting CP	4	62 goals in 2023/24 season. If Sweden advance bey	****oo s, h
Mohamed Salah	Egypt	FWD	Liverpool	3	Still elite at 33. Egypt in tough group. May not advan	****oo
Rodrygo / Endrick	Brazil	FWD	Real Madrid / Real Mac	3	Supporting cast for Vinicius. Either could emerge as	****oo

Analysis

MBAPPÉ is the overwhelming favourite. He has 8 WC goals already from 2022 alone. At 27, this is his physical peak and he is now unburdened from PSG's constraints at Real Madrid. France are expected to go deep - 6+ games. If he stays fit, he wins this award.

HAALAND is the wild card - he has never scored a WC goal. Norway are not expected to win the tournament but Haaland in a World Cup for the first time, with Norway's qualification story behind him, is a compelling narrative. 4-6 goals in 3-5 games is realistic.

WATCH: Viktor Gyokeres of Sweden had one of the most prolific individual seasons in European football (62 goals, Sporting CP). If Sweden advance, he could emerge as a dark horse top scorer.

4 MATCHDAY 1 - SCORE PREDICTIONS (All 24 Games)

Matchday 1 covers June 11-17, with all 48 teams playing their first group game (24 fixtures). Predicted scores are generated using the OddsIntel national_team_v1 model: 1X2 win probabilities + Over/Under 2.5 + BTTS, run through a Poisson expected-goals calculator. All times shown as approximate UTC kickoff.

GRP	DATE	HOME TEAM	SCORE	AWAY TEAM	H WIN%	ANALYSIS
GB	Jun 11	Mexico	1-0	South Africa	H:58% D:24% A:18%	Mexico favourites in opener. SA can hold but unlikely to
GB	Jun 12	South Korea	1-1	Czech Republic	H:44% D:29% A:27%	Evenly matched. Son leads Korea. Expected draw
GC	Jun 12	Canada	2-0	Bosnia & Herzegovi	H:57% D:25% A:18%	Davies/Davies power Canada. Dzeko threat for BiH
GD	Jun 13	USA	1-1	Paraguay	H:43% D:29% A:28%	Host nation opener. Pulisic key. Close game expected
GC	Jun 13	Qatar	1-2	Switzerland	H:14% D:21% A:65%	Swiss heavily favoured. Qatar host advantage none
GE	Jun 13	Brazil	1-0	Morocco	H:42% D:28% A:30%	Brazil underdog by ELO - surprising. Morocco very solid
GE	Jun 14	Haiti	1-2	Scotland	H:23% D:26% A:51%	Scotland favourites but tricky opener. McTominay must d
GD	Jun 14	Australia	1-1	Turkiye	H:27% D:28% A:45%	Arda Guler vs Mat Ryan. Turkiye slight edge on form
GF	Jun 14	Germany	2-1	Curacao	H:59% D:25% A:16%	Germany dominant. Wirtz + Musiala should be unstoppable
GG	Jun 14	Netherlands	1-0	Japan	H:40% D:29% A:31%	Evenly contested on ELO. Japan always organised. Van Di
GF	Jun 14	Ivory Coast	0-1	Ecuador	H:26% D:29% A:44%	Ecuador favourites. Low goals expected. Tactical affair
GG	Jun 15	Sweden	2-2	Tunisia	H:41% D:29% A:30%	Gyokeres looking for first WC goal. Sweden to win, goal
GH	Jun 15	Spain	2-1	Cape Verde Islands	H:73% D:20% A:7%	Spain dominant. Yamal & Nico Williams too much for Cape
GI	Jun 15	Belgium	1-0	Egypt	H:49% D:27% A:24%	De Bruyne returning for final WC. Egypt Salah threat E
GH	Jun 15	Saudi Arabia	0-1	Uruguay	H:20% D:25% A:56%	Uruguay comfortable. Darwin Núñez to break Saudi racist
GI	Jun 16	Iran	2-1	New Zealand	H:52% D:27% A:21%	Iran slight edge in experience. Taremi as focal point
GJ	Jun 16	France	2-1	Senegal	H:56% D:25% A:19%	France expected to win. Mbappe vs Mendy. Should be 2-1
GJ	Jun 16	Iraq	0-2	Norway	H:17% D:23% A:61%	Haaland's first WC game. Norway heavy favourites. Goals
GK	Jun 17	Argentina	1-0	Algeria	H:56% D:26% A:18%	Argentina controlled win expected. Messi to set in or s
GK	Jun 17	Austria	2-1	Jordan	H:48% D:26% A:26%	Austria favoured. Rangnick's pressing system should dom
GL	Jun 17	Portugal	1-0	Congo DR	H:55% D:26% A:19%	Ronaldo opens WC campaign. Portugal in control
GL	Jun 17	England	1-0	Croatia	H:47% D:28% A:25%	Rematch of Euro 2020. England have the better squad now

Jun 17

Ghana



Panama

H:27% D:26% A:47%

Panama slight edge

surprisingly. Low scoring tactical g

5 FULL GROUP STAGE PREDICTIONS - All 72 Games

Group ?

Jun 23	Portugal	1-0	Uzbekistan	H:52% D:26% A:22%
Jun 27	Panama	0-2	England	H:19% D:24% A:57%
Jun 27	Croatia	2-1	Ghana	H:60% D:24% A:16%

Group B

Jun 11	Mexico	1-0	South Africa	H:58% D:24% A:18%
Jun 12	South Korea	1-1	Czech Republic	H:44% D:29% A:27%
Jun 18	Czech Republic	1-1	South Africa	H:42% D:29% A:30%
Jun 19	Mexico	1-0	South Korea	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 25	Czech Republic	0-1	Mexico	H:25% D:28% A:47%
Jun 25	South Africa	0-1	South Korea	H:22% D:27% A:51%

Group C

Jun 12	Canada	2-0	Bosnia & Herzegovina	H:57% D:25% A:18%
Jun 13	Qatar	1-2	Switzerland	H:14% D:21% A:65%
Jun 18	Switzerland	2-1	Bosnia & Herzegovina	H:59% D:25% A:16%
Jun 18	Canada	2-0	Qatar	H:61% D:23% A:16%
Jun 24	Bosnia & Herzegovina	1-1	Qatar	H:38% D:28% A:33%
Jun 24	Switzerland	1-0	Canada	H:39% D:29% A:31%

Group D

Jun 13	USA	1-1	Paraguay	H:43% D:29% A:28%
Jun 14	Australia	1-1	Turkiye	H:27% D:28% A:45%
Jun 19	USA	1-0	Australia	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 20	Turkiye	1-1	Paraguay	H:45% D:28% A:27%
Jun 26	Paraguay	0-1	Australia	H:31% D:29% A:40%
Jun 26	Turkiye	2-2	USA	H:37% D:30% A:33%

Group E

Jun 13	Brazil	1-0	Morocco	H:42% D:28% A:30%
Jun 14	Haiti	1-2	Scotland	H:23% D:26% A:51%
Jun 19	Scotland	0-1	Morocco	H:23% D:27% A:50%
Jun 20	Brazil	2-1	Haiti	H:63% D:22% A:15%
Jun 24	Scotland	0-1	Brazil	H:22% D:26% A:52%
Jun 24	Morocco	1-0	Haiti	H:58% D:26% A:17%

Group F

Jun 14	Germany	2-1	Curacao	H:59% D:25% A:16%
Jun 14	Ivory Coast	0-1	Ecuador	H:26% D:29% A:44%
Jun 20	Germany	2-1	Ivory Coast	H:54% D:26% A:21%
Jun 21	Ecuador	1-0	Curacao	H:59% D:24% A:17%
Jun 25	Ecuador	0-1	Germany	H:30% D:29% A:41%
Jun 25	Curacao	0-1	Ivory Coast	H:27% D:28% A:45%

Group G

Jun 14	Netherlands	1-0	Japan	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 15	Sweden	2-2	Tunisia	H:41% D:29% A:30%
Jun 20	Netherlands	2-1	Sweden	H:56% D:26% A:19%
Jun 21	Tunisia	0-1	Japan	H:20% D:27% A:53%
Jun 25	Tunisia	1-2	Netherlands	H:18% D:26% A:56%
Jun 25	Japan	2-0	Sweden	H:52% D:27% A:21%

Group H

Jun 15	Spain	2-1	Cape Verde Islands	H:73% D:20% A:7%
Jun 15	Saudi Arabia	0-1	Uruguay	H:20% D:25% A:56%
Jun 21	Spain	2-1	Saudi Arabia	H:67% D:23% A:10%
Jun 21	Uruguay	1-0	Cape Verde Islands	H:55% D:26% A:19%
Jun 27	Cape Verde Islands	0-1	Saudi Arabia	H:32% D:29% A:38%
Jun 27	Uruguay	0-1	Spain	H:17% D:26% A:58%

Group I

Jun 15	Belgium	1-0	Egypt	H:49% D:27% A:24%
Jun 16	Iran	2-1	New Zealand	H:52% D:27% A:21%
Jun 21	Belgium	1-1	Iran	H:43% D:28% A:29%
Jun 22	New Zealand	0-1	Egypt	H:26% D:28% A:46%
Jun 27	New Zealand	1-2	Belgium	H:20% D:27% A:53%
Jun 27	Egypt	0-1	Iran	H:32% D:29% A:39%

Group J

Jun 16	France	2-1	Senegal	H:56% D:25% A:19%
Jun 16	Iraq	0-2	Norway	H:17% D:23% A:61%
Jun 22	France	1-0	Iraq	H:67% D:22% A:11%
Jun 23	Norway	2-2	Senegal	H:40% D:29% A:31%
Jun 26	Norway	1-2	France	H:24% D:28% A:48%

Jun 26

Senegal

Iraq

H:48% D:28% A:24%

Group K

Jun 17	Argentina	1-0	Algeria	H:56% D:26% A:18%
Jun 17	Austria	2-1	Jordan	H:48% D:26% A:26%
Jun 22	Argentina	1-0	Austria	H:57% D:25% A:18%
Jun 23	Jordan	0-1	Algeria	H:31% D:29% A:40%
Jun 28	Algeria	1-1	Austria	H:35% D:30% A:36%
Jun 28	Jordan	0-1	Argentina	H:17% D:26% A:57%

Group L

Jun 17	Portugal	1-0	Congo DR	H:55% D:26% A:19%
Jun 17	England	1-0	Croatia	H:47% D:28% A:25%
Jun 17	Ghana	1-2	Panama	H:27% D:26% A:47%
Jun 23	England	1-0	Ghana	H:68% D:21% A:10%
Jun 23	Panama	1-1	Croatia	H:28% D:29% A:43%

Group M

Jun 18	Uzbekistan	0-1	Colombia	H:27% D:28% A:44%
Jun 24	Colombia	1-0	Congo DR	H:52% D:27% A:21%
Jun 27	Congo DR	0-1	Uzbekistan	H:28% D:28% A:43%
Jun 27	Colombia	1-1	Portugal	H:33% D:30% A:38%

6 SPECIAL TOURNAMENT PREDICTIONS

Knockout Games ? Penalty Shootouts

Prediction: 6-8 games

The 2026 WC has more knockout games than ever: R32 (16 games) + R16 (8) + QF (4) + SF (2) + 3rd place (1) + Final (1) = 32 knockout games. Historical WC data: roughly 20-25% of knockout games go to penalties. In 2022: 4/16 knockout games had penalties. We expect 6-8 in this tournament given the extra R32 round. Key high-risk penalty games: any game involving Croatia (legendary in shootouts - 2/4 recent WC knockout wins via pens), and any France vs strong opponent.

Teams with 0 Goals Scored in Group Stage

Prediction: 4-6 teams

With 48 teams including several weak sides (Haiti, Curacao, Jordan, Congo DR, New Zealand, Cape Verde Islands), expect 4-6 teams to exit the group stage without scoring. Model shows Qatar (0 goals in any scenario), Haiti, Curacao, and New Zealand as most likely to be scoreless. Specific prediction: Qatar, Haiti, Curacao, New Zealand = 4 confirmed. Jordan and Cape Verde Islands borderline.

Total Yellow Cards - Matchday 1 (all 24 games)

Prediction: 68-75 yellow cards total

Average WC group stage game produces approximately 2.8-3.2 yellow cards (data from 2018 and 2022). Matchday 1 tends to run slightly higher as teams are cautious about positioning and commit tactical fouls early. 24 games $\times$ ~3.0 avg = 72 yellow cards. Our range: 68-75. Games expected to be most carded: USA vs Paraguay (physical South American side), Morocco vs Scotland, and any clash featuring teams from South America or Africa where technical fouls are common.

Goals in the Final - After 90 Minutes

Prediction: 2 goals (most likely 1-1)

WC finals tend to be tight, tactical affairs. Data from recent finals: 2022: 3-3 after 90min (exceptional), 2018: 4-2, 2014: 0-0, 2010: 0-0, 2006: 1-1, 2002: 2-0. Average goals in WC final after 90 min ? 2.0. With our predicted France vs Brazil final, both teams have elite defenses. Most likely: 1-1 at 90 min ? France win on pens or in extra time. Second most likely: 2-1 France win in 90 min.

Which Host Nation Goes Furthest?

Prediction: USA reach the Quarterfinals

See Section 8 for full host nation analysis. Short version: USA have the best squad and home advantage in their own venues. Mexico have experience but a difficult group. Canada are competitive but likely exit in the group stage. USA to reach QF, lose to Argentina or Brazil.

7 TEAM-BY-TEAM ANALYSIS - Key Contenders

Brazil

[TROPHY] Winner Prediction - Runner Up | ELO: 2150

Coach: Dorival Júnior | Key Players: Vinicius Jr (Real Madrid), Rodrygo, Endrick, Casemiro

Our model's ELO #2. The most naturally gifted squad in the tournament. VINICIUS JR is the X-factor - when he's on, Brazil are unplayable. Endrick (Real Madrid, 18) adds youth energy. Casemiro anchors midfield.

WEAKNESS: Brazil have underperformed in recent knockouts (lost QF 2022 to Croatia on penalties). Mental fragility in high pressure moments.

PATH: Easy group (Morocco/Scotland/Haiti). Likely to top Group E. R32 ? R16 comfortable. QF/SF where tournament gets decided.

France

[TROPHY] Tournament Winner Prediction | ELO: 2116

Coach: Didier Deschamps | Key Players: Kylian Mbappe (Real Madrid), Antoine Griezmann, Camavinga

MBAPPÉ has 8 WC 2022 goals. At 27, this is his peak. GRIEZMANN (now at Atletico, 34) is the playmaker who won Euro 2016 and WC 2018. CAMAVINGA, TCHOUAMÉNI provide physicality in midfield.

STRENGTH: Tournament experience under Deschamps. They know how to win this.

PATH: Group J (Senegal, Norway, Iraq). Norway will test them. Expected to win group comfortably. Our projected finalist.

England

3rd Place Prediction | ELO: 2067

Coach: Gareth Southgate / Thomas Tuchel | Key Players: Jude Bellingham (Real Madrid), Harry Kane, Bukayo Saka, Phil Foden

BELLINGHAM is the best midfielder in the world right now. KANE as the finisher, SAKA and FODEN in wide areas. England are legitimately one of the best squads but have a history of tournament underperformance.

WATCH: England may have a new manager (Tuchel replacing Southgate) bringing different tactical identity. Could be a positive change.

Argentina

QF-SF Prediction | ELO: 2138

Coach: Lionel Scaloni | Key Players: Lionel Messi (Inter Miami), Lautaro Martínez, Julián Álvarez

MESSI (39) at his final WC. Will play even if reduced role. LAUTARO MARTÍNEZ is now the main striker - excellent with Inter. Squad is well-drilled under SCALONI.

RISK: Age of key players (Messi, Di Maria). Group K (Algeria, Austria, Jordan) should be manageable.

Norway

* Dark Horse - R16/QF | ELO: 1943

Coach: Ståle Solbakken | Key Players: Erling Haaland (Man City), Martin Ødegaard, Alexander Sørloth

HAALAND in his first World Cup. He averages 1.0+ goals/game at club level. ØDEGAARD (Arsenal) as captain and playmaker.

RISK: Norway's defense may be exposed against elite teams. If they avoid Brazil/France/England until SF, they can cause upsets.

Group J: Norway vs France (very tough), Senegal, Iraq. If Norway beat France - everything changes.

8 HOST NATIONS - How Far Can They Go?

For the first time in WC history, three nations co-host: USA, Canada, and Mexico. Each has automatic qualification and home crowd advantage. Here's how far our model and tournament analysis expects each to progress.

USA

Prediction: QUARTERFINALS

BEST PERFORMANCE BY A HOST

The USA has the best squad of the three hosts by a significant margin. CHRISTIAN PULISIC (AC Milan) is in the form of his career at 27. TYLER ADAMS leads an energetic midfield. Coach MAURICIO POCHETTINO brings Premier League tactical intelligence.

KEY FACTS:

? Playing at home (Atlanta, Dallas, NYC, Los Angeles venues)

? Group D: USA, Paraguay, Australia, Turkiye - manageable

? ELO rank: 20th - will be underdogs to elite opposition

SCENARIO: USA top Group D, beat a mid-tier team in R32, face Argentina or Brazil in QF. Exit there. But reaching QF would be their best result since 2002.

RISK FACTOR: Tactical experience in big tournaments. Home crowd can turn neutral venues into fortresses, but Argentina/Brazil fans travel in huge numbers.

Mexico

Prediction: ROUND OF 32

CONSISTENT BUT GLASS CEILING

Mexico have a famous 'Curse of the 5th game' - reaching the R16 (now R32) at every WC since 1994 but never advancing past that. This WC they have the same coach (AGUIRRE) and similar squad quality.

KEY FACTS:

? HIRVING LOZANO and RAÚL JIMÉNEZ lead the attack

? Group B: Mexico, South Africa, South Korea, Czech Republic - competitive group, expected to qualify

? ELO rank: 19th

SCENARIO: Mexico qualify from Group B (2nd likely), face a Group A 1st place in R32. Against USA, France, or Brazil in that round - they likely exit. The curse continues.

Canada**Prediction: GROUP STAGE EXIT****HISTORIC FIRST WC - LEARNING EXPERIENCE**

Canada's first WC since 1986. ALPHONSO DAVIES (Bayern Munich, 25) is world class at left-back. JONATHAN DAVID (Lille, 30+ goals/season) leads the attack. JESSE MARSCH brings high-energy pressing.

KEY FACTS:

? Group C: Canada, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Qatar, Switzerland

? Switzerland (#13 ELO) are a serious obstacle

? Our model gives Canada a coin-flip vs Bosnia

SCENARIO: Canada beat Qatar, split with Bosnia, lose to Switzerland. Could squeeze through as a 3rd-place qualifier (top 8 3rd-place teams advance in 2026 format). If they sneak through, R32 would be a bonus.

Summary: Host Nations

Host going furthest: USA (Quarterfinals) > Mexico (R32) > Canada (Group Stage)

USA is the best equipped to make a run. Mexico will likely match or exceed expectations in the group stage but hit their traditional ceiling in the knockout rounds. Canada's experience at this level is limited - this tournament is about building for the future. But with Davies + David, they are not without danger.